ASP.NET Core Web API Tutorials

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Web API is a new framework, which supports the creation of HTTP services. Web API can be used to build services that run on the web and may be accessed from a browser or other devices. Web API is a good platform for building RESTful applications on the .NET Framework. Web API is an ideal platform for building non-SOAP based services. Web API provides a flexible way to create services that can be hosted in IIS or self-host in other processes. Web API also supports the MVC model and provides a rich routing infrastructure, model binding and validation, OAuth or Identity based security, unit testing, IoC container, LINQ, Entity Framework, and many other features that are useful for building web services.

Web API Features

Web API supports Representational State Transfer (REST) architecture. Web API provides a flexible way to create services that can be hosted in IIS or self-host in other processes. Web API also supports the MVC model and provides a rich routing infrastructure, model binding and validation, OAuth or Identity based security, unit testing, IoC container, LINQ, Entity Framework, and many other features that are useful for building web services.

Web API Vs MVC

Both the Web API and MVC framework are similar in many ways. Both the Web API and MVC framework are built on top of the ASP.NET platform. Both the Web API and MVC framework support the MVC pattern, routing, model binding and validation, filters, dependency injection, and many other features. However, the Web API is a lightweight framework for building web services that can be hosted in IIS or self-host in other processes. The Web API is better suited for building web services than MVC.

Prerequisites

- **Visual Studio Prerequisites:** Microsoft Visual Studio Express 2013 for Web or higher version is required to run the examples in this tutorial. Microsoft Visual Studio Express 2013 for Web is a free version of Microsoft Visual Studio. Microsoft Visual Studio Express 2013 for Web can be downloaded from the Microsoft website.
- **Web API Prerequisites:** Knowledge of ASP.NET Web Forms or ASP.NET MVC is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of HTTP is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of JSON is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of JavaScript is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of jQuery is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of AngularJS is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of Entity Framework is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of LINQ is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of Dependency Injection is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of Unit Testing is helpful but not required to learn Web API. Knowledge of Inversion of Control